

## **Minutes – Cincinnati Contra Board Meeting**

**May 4, 2025 7:00 pm**

**Present:** Steve Edwards, Cori Yaeger, Valerie Allendorf, Larry Lankford, Josh Telecsan, Bonnie Carpenter, Philip Ogsten, Myra Mitchell, Charles Wallner, Deven Corzine, Michael Hentz, Audrey Eyman. **Absent:** Kurt Grannan.

Meeting started 7:10 pm

### **Introduction**

**Meeting Minutes** from 04/06/25 - - approved by consensus.

**Treasurer's Report** - Larry – approved by consensus. Philip asked whether we know if there are people who are contributing more than cost of dance. Larry responded only if designated on a check as a donation. Dancing income correlates to the attendance numbers that Larry includes in the spreadsheet. Larry indicated that we typically lose money on our Monday and Saturday dances, but make up for it with Pigtown profits.

**Secretary's report** - Cori – membership & **annual meeting (Monday, October 13)** Cori proposed that she would pay people's membership in order to simplify the process of renewing. Renewals are slow. A few board members indicated that we might raise our dues; others disagreed. Decision by consensus: Cori will send an email out to the folks who have been voting members in the past three years and indicate that they can put their \$1 in the cash box envelope for membership. The email will indicate how many events must be attended (bylaws quoted for membership requirements), and ask for the name, mailing address, email and phone for members. An email may be sent to the larger "regional list" after sending to recent former members.

**Succession** – Cori requested someone on the board be willing to take over as secretary and shadow her as she works through the annual meeting process.

**WFAC report** —Josh notified WFAC about plans to diagnose the non-working speaker and received no objections. He and Philip will move ahead with checking out the speaker.

**Social Secretary Report** – no one died or had major medical issues this month.

**Scheduling Report** – Bonnie and Deven Reported that Liz Burkhart has agreed to call for Raven and Goose. The second half of the year's schedule is out – waiting for confirmations.

Rosenthorns had to cancel due to illness and Trillium filled in. Bonnie asked about the procedure in case we need to cancel the dance. Recorded music is an option if someone wants to put together a list. Spotify music is often too short

**Techno** discussion – hopefully have an opening for that in the future. Deven indicated that Polly suggested instead of it being called “techno” it be called “DJ contra.” Trying to get something set up. Maybe set for after the regular Saturday dance. Asked Deven to check with Polly and Darlene about setting up. Maybe also checking with Kenny Greer. Audrey and Charles think we need to promote at least 4-6 weeks in advance. Others thought a shorter lead time might be okay if it is an add-on to Saturday night.

## **Old Business**

**Pigtown** – Valerie presented budget for PTF 2026 - \$32,255.85 including a 15% “uncertainty” increase. Also, need folks who are willing to get new folks involved in the PTF process – folks to mentor etc. Need more volunteers and work-trade for next year (separate from the mentoring for the planning committee.)

Philip asked if possible to charge more admission to cover costs. Valerie pointed out that we charged \$15 for the lunch on Saturday. Maybe charge \$5 for Sunday brunch. Charles concerned about raising prices – maybe need to be competitive with other dances. Steve indicated that keeping fees the same and bring in more people (20+) would cover costs and not be overcrowded. Deven made a motion to accept the proposed budget. Cori seconded the motion. Accepted by consensus.

**Website** – Kurt (absent)

**New callers** – Steve suggested new callers work with scheduled callers.

**Google Drive** progress – nothing to report.

**Board retreat:** Audrey and Cori met and reviewed the schedule preferences for Saturday 7/26/25 9am-4pm. (Valerie not able to attend that date). 248 Lakengren Drive, Eaton, OH. Options 2 and 3 most popular (2. recruiting and stabilizing per mission/vision 3. Financial Planning. Audrey indicated that she co-facilitated with our chosen facilitator and she did great at a Miami workshop with 25 attendees. Audrey will invite facilitator to attend a dance and/or a board meeting before the retreat.

**Everybody's Dance Insurance** – Larry checked with CDSS – and we can't just “add” them to our policy. They could become “part” of CCD (as we do with Waltz Evenings). Larry sent a proposal to Hazel (organizer) indicating that ED would report to CCD monthly and CCD would handle the profits/losses. Hazel responded that she will take our proposal to ED planning committee and let us know. They would have to abide by our bylaws.

## **Proposal for Scheduling Touring Bands for Saturday and Monday Dances**

Following proposal made by Steve:

“CCD currently has many (11) excellent regularly scheduled Core Bands which we want to support with sufficient times to play. We also want to support “touring bands” for variety and cooperative spirit.

Touring Bands may be scheduled up to a total of 4 (*proposed by Steve*) 6 (*proposed by Philip*) times per year, either Saturday or Monday. For "Big Name" Bands with larger expenses, Saturday is preferred. At least two (3) bands may be chosen by CCD and up to two (3) bands who request a date with CCD. CCD's Scheduler will accept bands' fees with Board consultation for cases that Scheduler deems above normal.”

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Audrey suggested leaving to schedulers' discretion whether a local band gets asked to change their date for a touring band.

Bonnie asked how to determine how much to spend. Charles suggested maybe we have a budget for this. Also those decisions need to be made by Deven and Bonnie together.

Philip suggested the board approve a budget each 6 months and leave the decisions about how that money is spent to the schedulers.

Valerie brought up the issue of local bands and callers not yet being paid well enough for their work with CCD.

Philip suggested that the actual amounts will likely be discussed at our retreat.

Myra suggested that Bonnie and Deven propose a budget and have the board approve it.

## **New Business**

- Length of Saturday dances - tabled

- Vendor's permit? - tabled

- Advertising for new dancers – PSAs and local publications. - tabled

Next meeting: June 1-, 2025, 7:00 pm zoom